

Natalia I. Valdez-Gonzalez

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Behavioral/Experimental Economics, Policy, Consumer Behavior, Neuroeconomics

EMPLOYMENT

Postdoctoral Researcher

2023 - present

Universitat de Barcelona

Department of Economics

Visiting Lecturer

2023 (Spring semester)

University of Tennessee Knoxville

Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics

Lab Manager, Human Behavior Lab

2018 - 2023

Texas A&M University

Department of Agricultural Economics

Graduate Assistant Researcher

2016 - 2022

Texas A&M University

Department of Agricultural Economics

Research Associate, Center on Conflict and Development

2014 - 2016

Texas A&M University

Department of Agricultural Economics

Economist Intern

2013 (Summer)

United States International Trade Commission

Office of Economics

EDUCATION

PhD Agricultural Economics

2023

Texas A&M University

Adviser: Dr. Marco Palma

Master of International Affairs

2014

Bush School of Government & Public Service Texas A&M University

Major: International Economics and Development

Bachelor of Arts

2012

Texas A&M University

Major: Economics and French

Minor: Mathematics

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Articles

Valdez Gonzalez, N.I., Brown, A.L., and M.A. Palma. 2025. "Social-benefits stigma subsequent competitiveness." *Economic Inquiry*, 63(3), 903-925.

Liu, H., Qu, N., **Valdez Gonzalez, N.I.**, Palma, M.A., Chen, H., Xiong, J., Choubey, A., Li, Y., Li, X., Yu, M., Liu, H., Tu, L., Zhang, N., Yin, N., Conde, K.M., Wang, M., Bean, J.C., Han, J., Scarcelli, N.A., Yang, Y., Saito, K., Cui, H., Tong, Q., Sun, Z., Wang, C., Cai, X., Lu, L., He, Y. and Y. Xu. 2024. "A light-responsive neural circuit suppresses feeding." *Journal of Neuroscience*, 44 (30).

Valdez Gonzalez, N.I., Kee, J.Y., Palma, M.A., and J.R. Pruitt. 2024. "The Relationship between Monetary Incentives, Social Status, and Physical Activity." *Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics*, 108, 102155.

Other Articles

Kibriya, S., Tkach, B., Ahn, J., Valdez Gonzalez, N., Xu, Z., & Y. Zhang. 2016. "The Effects of School-Related Gender-Based Violence on Academic Performance: Evidence from Botswana, Ghana, and South Africa." USAID.

WORKING PAPERS

Valdez-Gonzalez, N.I., Gaviria, A., and A.M. Espin. "Addressing confounding factors does not eliminate the gender gap in competition entry: evidence from seven countries." *Under Review*

Valdez-Gonzalez, N.I., Palma, M.A., and Y. Xu. "The effect of bright light exposure on reciprocity."

WORKS IN PROGRESS

"Are Elicited Social Norms Robust to Emotional Framing? Evidence from Care" (with P. Brañas and C. Patxot), *Registered Report Submitted*

"Order effects, personal norms, and motivated reasoning in caregiving reports"

"Confidence in ambiguous benchmarks" (with D. Just and M.A. Palma)

"How do macroeconomic expectations affect food consumption planning? Evidence from U.S. consumer surveys" (with S. Huseynov, D. Altindag, J. Cuffey, and W. Li)

"The concept of altruism in human neuroscience: A scoping review" (with M. Aisa-Gomez, M. Tejada, L. Eudave, G. Arrondo, J. Bernacer, M. Martinez)

"Transparency as a tool for increasing productivity" (with V. Vitaku)

"Household expectations and the Fed's dual mandate" (with S. Huseynov and Y. Jo)

CONFERENCES, WORKSHOPS, & PRESENTATIONS

2026: Loyola Behavioral Lab (Cordoba, Spain); Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (Kansas City, MO, USA); Economic Sciences Association Europe (Barcelona, Spain); Behavioral Economics Science and Technology Conference (College Station, TX, USA)

2025: 5th Meeting of the Society for Advancement of Judgment and Decision-Making Studies (Barcelona, Spain); Economic Sciences Association Europe (Brno, Czech Republic); BSE Summer Forum (Tournaments: Theory, Experiments, and Applications, Barcelona, Spain)

2024: Economic Sciences Association North America (Columbus, OH, USA); Economic Sciences Association Europe (Helsinki, Finland); UB Microeconomics Workshop (Barcelona, Spain)

2023: Southern Agricultural Economics Association (Oklahoma City, OK, USA)

2022: Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (Anaheim, CA, USA))

2021: Economic Sciences Association North America Tuscon, AZ, USA); Economic Sciences Association Around-the-Clock meetings (virtual, moderator); Agricultural and Applied Economics Association (Austin, TX, USA, moderator)

2020: Southern Agricultural Economics Association (Louisville, KY, moderator)

REFeree ACTIVITY

Journal of Behavioral and Experimental Economics, Journal of Economic Behavior and Organization, AAEA annual meeting abstract review (Experimental Economics and Agribusiness Management)

GRANTS

Juan de la Cierva Postdoctoral fellowship, €72,000, February 2025

The International Foundation for Research in Experimental Economics (IFREE) Small Grants Program, \$10,000, October 2019

TEACHING

Courses

Instructor

Course Title: Microeconomic Applications to Ag & Resource Markets (AREC 550, Master's level)

Department of Agricultural and Resource Economics at the University of Tennessee Knoxville

Spring 2023

Co-Instructor

Course Title: Research Methodology (AGEC 607, Master's level)

Department of Agricultural Economics at Texas A&M University

Spring 2021

Teaching Assistant

Course Title: Food Security, Climate, and Conflict (AGEC 489/689, hybrid undergraduate and graduate)

Department of Agricultural Economics at Texas A&M University

Spring 2016 & Spring 2017

Foreign Language Leader

Course Title: French

Bush School of Government & Public Service at Texas A&M University

Spring 2014

Teaching Assistant

Course Title: Introduction to French (FREN 101, 102, undergraduate level)

Department of International Studies at Texas A&M University

2010-2012 (4 semesters)

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- SAEA Best Job Market Paper: 2018
- Graduate Student Travel Grant: 2021, 2022
- The Graduate & Professional School Travel Scholarship (Texas A&M): 2022
- 2022 AAEA Travel Scholarship: 2022
- ConDev Graduate Research Fellowship: 2016
- Robert G. Cherry Graduate Fellowship: 2017-2018
- George and Barbara Bush Fellowship: 2013-2014
- Robert A Mosbacher, Sr Internship award: 2013
- Bush School General Scholarship: 2013

SKILLS

- Software: Stata, Latex, Excel, R, oTree (Python), iMotions
- Languages: English (native), Spanish (native), French (B2), Catalan (A2)

REFERENCES

Pablo Brañas
Professor of Behavioural Economics
Department of Economics
Universidad Loyola Andalucía
✉ branasgarza@gmail.com

Concepció Patxot
Professor
Department of Economics
Universitat de Barcelona
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Marco A. Palma
Professor
Department of Agricultural Economics
Texas A&M University
✉ mapalma@tamu.edu